

Refugee impacts are driving income and consumption toward Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!)

Key Messages

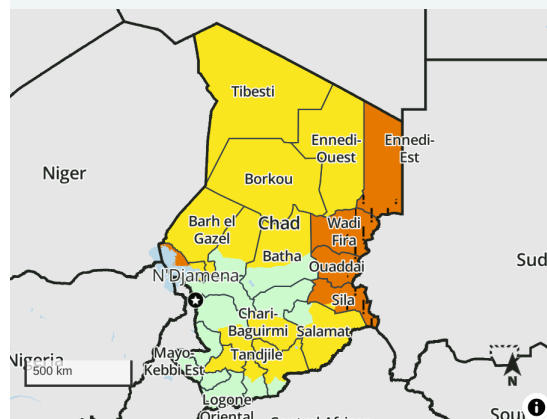
- **Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes are expected in the eastern departments with high concentrations of refugees (Ouaddaï, Sila, Wadi Fira, Ennedi-Est) through September 2026.** Refugees depend on markets, but are facing food consumption deficits due to limited income-generating activities and atypically high prices for imported food commodities. Access to food assistance is mitigating these deficits, but a small proportion of households, fewer than 15 percent, risk deteriorating into Emergency (IPC Phase 4).
- **Ongoing Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes in Lac Province (Fouli and Kaya) are expected to persist through September.** Persistent insecurity and continued displacement in Lac are limiting access to livelihoods for displaced and poor host households. During the peak of the lean season (June-August) in **North Kanem and North Barh El-Gazel (BEG), food access for poor households is expected to deteriorate, resulting in Crisis (IPC Phase 3).** Households will face the combined effects of increased market dependence, sustained food price increases, and seasonal declines in income.
- **In most provinces of the central and Sudanian zones, poor households are expected to remain Stressed (IPC Phase 2) through September 2026.** Food stocks are being depleted rapidly, and incomes are insufficient to cover essential non-food needs. However, households will maintain minimally adequate food consumption through in-kind payments from agricultural labor.
- The government estimates that the **conflict in the Middle East poses limited risks to food supply in Chad.** However, the **oil price shock**, in a context where fuel prices are already high (2,000 FCFA per liter of gasoline in some eastern localities), could affect transport costs, imports, and household purchasing power. It is expected to worsen food access difficulties for poor households whose incomes will decline during the lean season.

This report provides an update to the [February 2026 to September 2026 Food Security Outlook](#) and [March 2026 Key Message Update](#). The analysis is based on information available as of April 26, 2026.

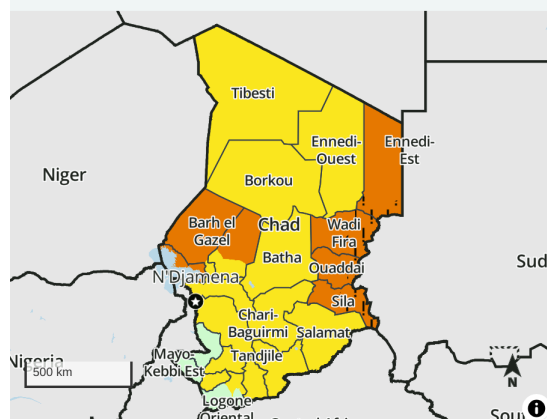
Current anomalies in food security conditions as of April 2026

- **The massive influx of Sudanese refugees remains the main driver of food insecurity in Chad.** Refugees are arriving without any means of livelihood. According to the [UN High Commissioner for Refugees \(UNHCR\)](#),

Projected area-level acute food insecurity outcomes, April - May 2026



Projected area-level acute food insecurity outcomes, June - September 2026



IPC 3.1 acute food insecurity classification

Sub-national level data

- | | | |
|-------------|--------------|-----------|
| 1: Minimal | 3: Crisis | 5: Famine |
| 2: Stressed | 4: Emergency | |

Symbols

- ! Would likely be at least one phase worse without current or planned humanitarian food assistance

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. For full disclosure, see endnotes.

Source: FEWS NET



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FEWS NET Chad

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as of April 27, 2026, around 926,421 new refugees had arrived in the eastern provinces since April 2023, particularly in Ennedi-Est, Ouaddaï, Sila, and Wadi Fira. The refugee presence is creating strong competition for employment, thereby worsening access to income and food for poor host households. As a result, food demand and market prices are also increasing, heightening dependence on food assistance, especially among newly arrived refugees.

- **The persistence of various conflicts is of concern for worsening food insecurity in Chad.** According to ACLED, 20 conflict events occurred in Chad between March 13 and April 10, 2026. These incidents caused 26 deaths and destroyed the livelihoods of 117,188 people. Recurring violence additionally affected 1,191 people, forcing displacement and causing movement restrictions in Lac Province. These conditions limit access to agricultural activities, fishing, and trade, while placing growing pressure on the livelihoods and resources of host communities. A drone attack on March 18 and an armed clash on March 22 between Chadian military forces and Sudan's Rapid Support Forces took place in Ouaddaï Province. This development further restricts cross-border flows and worsens already fragile food conditions in the eastern provinces.
- **Cereal production increased by 12 percent compared to 2024 and by 11.2 percent compared to the five-year average.** According to data revised in March 2026 by the Directorate of Agricultural Production and Statistics, cereal production for the 2025/2026 season is estimated at 3,035,565 metric tons, compared with 2,709,516 metric tons in 2024/25. However, **millet and sorghum production, the main staple cereals, declined by 3 percent and 17 percent, respectively, compared to the average.** The cereal balance sheet highlights gross deficits in wheat (99 percent of needs) and local cereals (10 percent of needs), which will have to be covered through imports. However, given the closure of the border with Sudan, persistent insecurity in Lac Province, and insecurity along the border with the Central African Republic, the local cereal deficit will be difficult to offset through imports.
- Local production and commercial stocks are ensuring a satisfactory cereal supply, but **food prices are rising seasonally compared to the five-year average**, except for millet, whose price is 16 percent below average. **However, the supply of imported food products has declined while their prices have risen sharply.** Insecurity, the closure of certain borders, and higher transport costs linked to elevated fuel prices have resulted in increases of 61 percent for imported rice and 74 percent for wheat flour compared to the average. In the eastern provinces, where refugee inflows and the closure of the Sudanese border are generating increased demand due to rapid stock depletion, price increases have been particularly severe, exceeding 100 percent. Livestock markets are also experiencing strong demand driven by Cameroonian and Nigerian traders and the resumption of exports to Libya. Prices remain above the five-year average, and livestock-to-cereal terms of trade continue to favor pastoralists.
- **Poor household incomes, mainly derived from the sale of local cereals, are atypically below average due to reduced millet and sorghum production and exceptionally low prices for millet and bérébéré (dry-season sorghum).** To cope with school expenses and debt repayment, households increased millet sales, despite millet being their main source of food and income. These large-scale sales created an oversupply in the market during the harvest period, driving prices down. The exceptionally abundant bérébéré harvest also failed to help households rebuild stocks because they were forced to sell large quantities for very little income. In Am Timan, in Salamat Province, an important bérébéré production zone, local markets became saturated, causing prices to collapse. The price of a 100 kilogram bag of berbere, which sold for as much as 35,000 FCFA in 2025, dropped to between 4,000 and 6,000 FCFA in March 2026.
- **The conflict in the Middle East presents limited risks of food shortages in Chad**, according to the government and the National Council of Chadian Importers, Investors, Industrialists, and Exporters (**CONITE**), because the country has diversified sources of supply. In the immediate term, the impact is reflected in reduced remittances from Chadians working in the Gulf. However, the country continues to face already high fuel prices (2,000 FCFA, or about 3.40 USD, per liter of gasoline in some eastern localities), which chronically affect transport costs, imports, and household purchasing power.

Humanitarian food assistance

- The food security component of the assistance plan was funded at only 4.4 percent in April. It is part of a broader humanitarian assistance plan developed in February by the government and its partners. The plan aims to provide humanitarian assistance to 3.4 million people at a total cost of 984.2 million USD, but it was only 22.5 percent funded as of April 17, 2026. On April 11, 2026, a joint report by UNHCR and WFP warned about insufficient funding for refugees. The negative effects are already visible in refugee camps in eastern Chad, where food rations were cut by half during the first quarter.

Updates to key assumptions about atypical food security conditions through September 2026

Most of the assumptions that underpinned FEWS NET's analysis of the most likely scenario for the [Chad February 2026 to September 2026 Food Security Outlook](#) remain valid; however, the following updates have been made to incorporate new evidence:

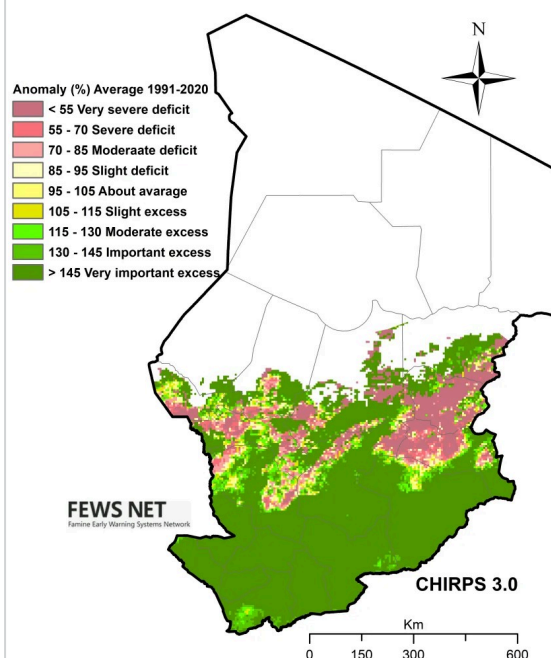
- The influx of Sudanese refugees and Chadian returnees into the eastern provinces is expected to continue throughout the projection period.** Despite a recent relative decline in monthly refugee inflows, the security situation in Sudan's Darfur and Kordofan regions remains volatile. Clashes between the Rapid Support Forces and the Sudanese army are expected to continue near El-Geneina and Adré (Darfur), with sporadic spillovers into Chadian territory.
- Although average to above-average rainfall is still expected **across all agropastoral zones of Chad, there is a high risk of flooding**, particularly in the Sudanian zone, between July and September 2026.
- With the rains already beginning in the Sudanian zone and the southern Sahel (Figure 1), **transhumance toward pastoral areas is expected to accelerate** to avoid an atypical resurgence of farmer-herder conflicts. **Localized increases in conflict are possible along transhumance corridors between April and May.** A relative calm is expected from June onward, with the completion of transhumance movements toward northern pastoral areas.
- The national pasture balance sheet**, published in March 2026, remains in surplus through the end of April (259 percent of needs), before **declining between May and June** (109 percent of needs), though still showing significant localized deficits in Lac, Kanem, BEG, Batha, Wadi Fira, and Ennedi-Est.
- The global oil shock could increase the cost of agricultural inputs, transport, and imports, heightening risks to food security.** Accelerated price inflation is anticipated, driven by above-average seasonal increases in imported goods, particularly in urban centers and high-demand areas of the eastern provinces. In addition, rising energy prices in Gulf countries, which play a key role in nitrogen fertilizer production, are **expected to trigger sharp increases in fertilizer prices and reduce fertilizer availability.**

Humanitarian food assistance

- The national response plan for households facing food insecurity during the 2026 lean season includes cash transfers totaling 53.6 billion FCFA for 1,005,773 people. It also provides humanitarian food assistance in kind valued at 67.9 billion FCFA for 1,376,189 people. However, the population targeted by this assistance consists

Figure 1

Rainfall anomaly, March 20-April 20, 2026



Source: USGS

only of host households in need during the lean season. For Sudanese refugees, the [WFP](#) plans to resume monthly food assistance distributions through July/August.

Projected acute food insecurity outcomes through September 2026

Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) outcomes are expected through September 2026 in departments with high concentrations of refugees: Assoungba (Ouaddaï), Kimiti (Sila), Wadi Hawar (Ennedi-Est), Dar-Tama, and Kobé (Wadi Fira). These provinces continue to experience an influx of refugees and returnees from Sudan, along with atypically high prices for imported food products. Host households are experiencing deteriorating food access due to the combined effects of early depletion of food stocks, strong market dependence, persistently high food prices, and declining income-earning opportunities. The massive influx of refugees is placing increasing pressure on local resources and further weakening the coping capacities of poor host households. Refugees, who are arriving without livelihoods, are facing severe food consumption deficits and depend heavily on food assistance, which is preventing Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes. Due to insufficient income, a growing proportion of households will increasingly resort to begging to survive. A share of these households, estimated at less than 15 percent of the population, is vulnerable to deteriorating into Emergency (IPC Phase 4).

Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are also expected through September 2026 in the remaining departments of Ouaddaï, Sila, Wadi Fira, and Ennedi-Est provinces, where the refugee presence is more limited. Poor households will depend exclusively on markets in a context of high prices. Seasonal declines in income and reduced borrowing opportunities will further constrain food access. Poor households will reduce the number of meals consumed and face food consumption deficits. At the peak of the lean season (between July and August), a small proportion of these households (around 5 percent) may resort to extreme coping strategies, particularly begging, and deteriorate into Emergency (IPC Phase 4).

Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are anticipated through September in Fouli and Kaya departments, affected by conflict in Lac Province. The deterioration of livelihoods, slowdown in markets, and near halt of cross-border trade will reduce incomes for host households and internally displaced persons (IDPs). This decline limits the amount of food accessible on markets and increases reliance on negative coping strategies, including consumption of cheaper foods, reducing meals, and borrowing food.

Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are also expected between June and September 2026 in North Kanem and North BEG. Seasonal increases in food prices, amplified by rising transport costs and deteriorating roads, will coincide with declining incomes linked to lower livestock prices and reduced sales of gathered products. Poor households are therefore likely to experience food consumption deficits.

Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are expected to persist through September 2026 in the northern provinces (Borkou, Ennedi-Ouest, and Tibesti). Poor households in these provinces are expected to maintain minimally adequate food consumption throughout the projection period due to income from cross-border trade, despite their market dependence and anticipated increases in imported food prices.

In the central and Sudanian zones, poor households in Salamat, Moyen-Chari, Tandjilé, and Guéra are expected to experience Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes beginning in April 2026. Residual stocks from bérébéré production and limited income from fruit sales will allow households to meet minimum food, but not non-food, needs.

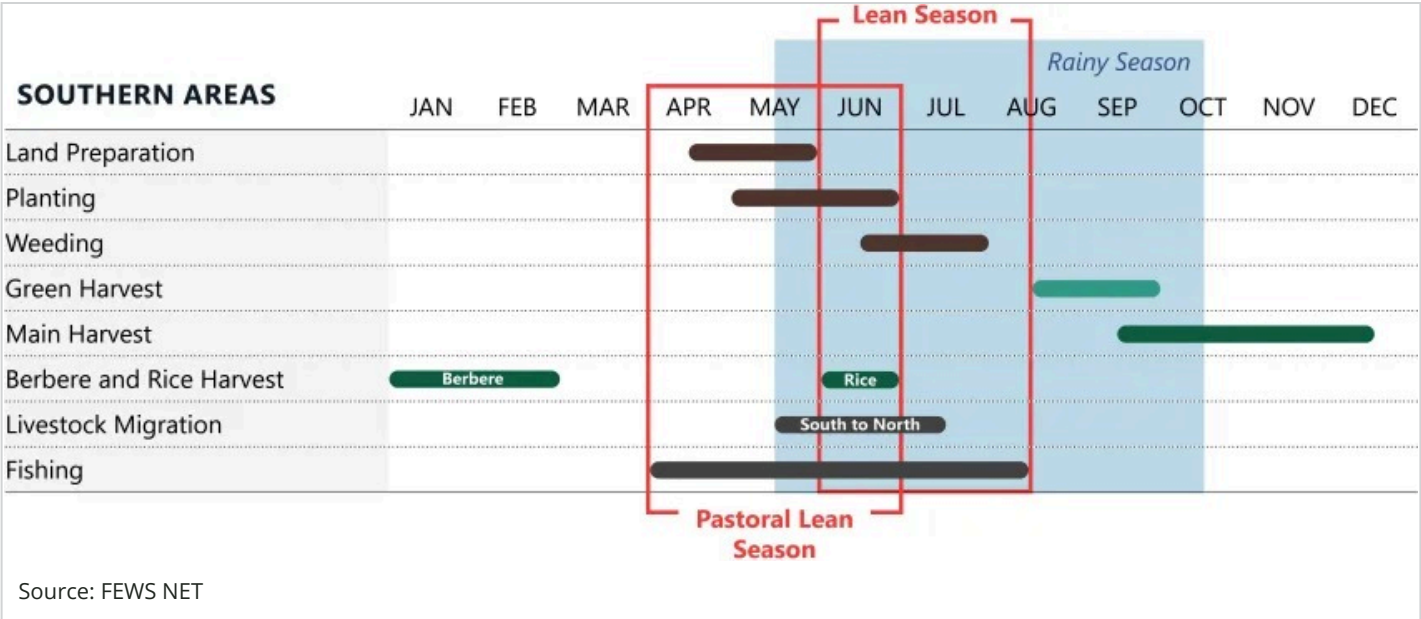
From June through September, Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are expected to expand across most departments in the central and Sudanian zones. Poor households will face widespread depletion of food stocks, rising prices, and sharply reduced purchasing power due to weak income from agricultural labor and limited borrowing opportunities. Households will be able to maintain limited food consumption due to in-kind payments, but will have no remaining income to cover essential non-food needs.

Annex 1: Updates to key sources of evidence used in this analysis

Many of the key sources of evidence utilized for FEWS NET's [February 2026 to September 2026 Food Security Outlook](#) remain the same; however, new and additional sources of evidence are listed below.

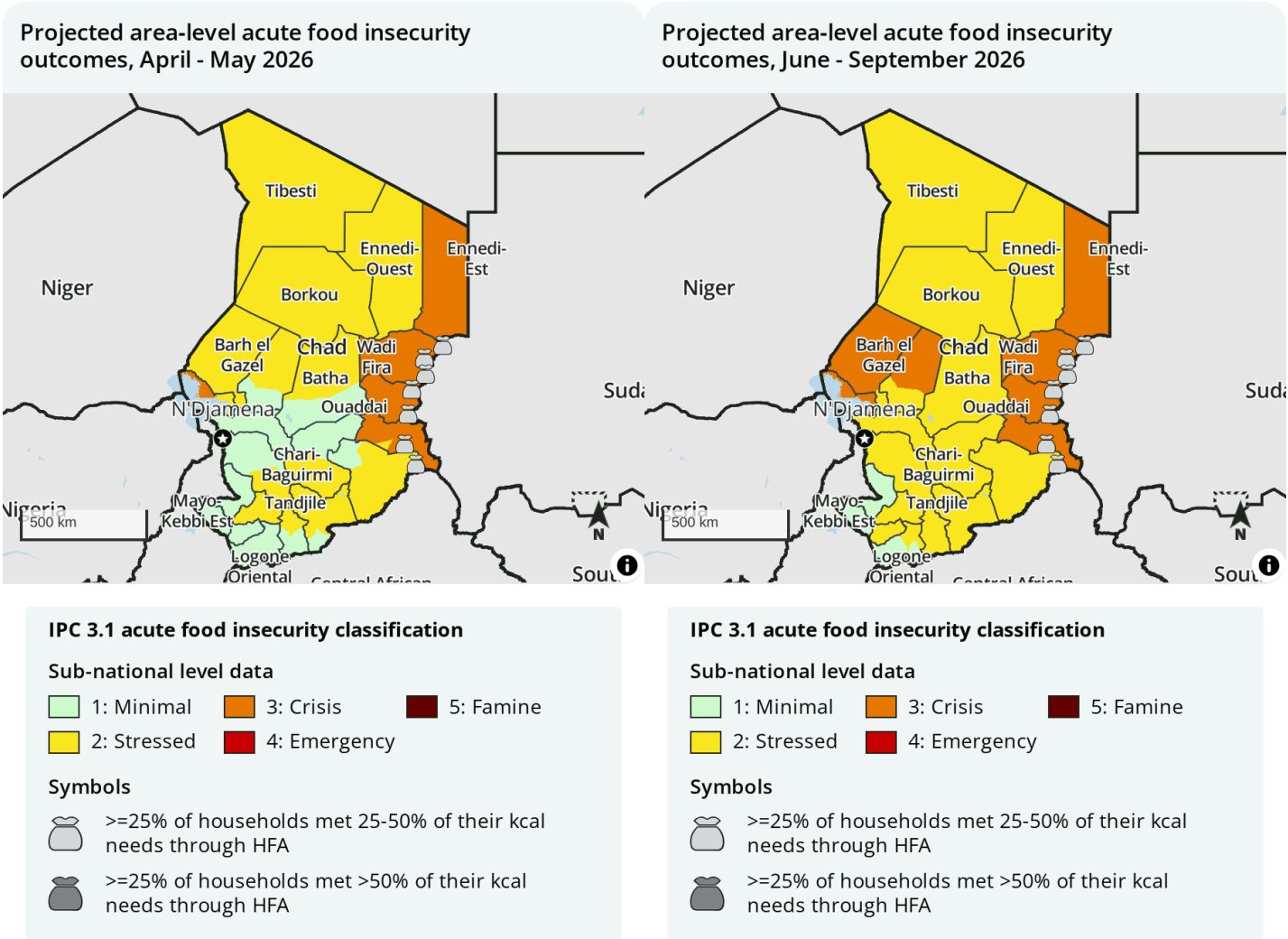
Evidence	Source	Data format	Food security element of analysis
Weather monitoring and forecasting	FEWS NET/USGS, NOAA , FEWS NET Agroclimatology Team	Quantitative	Rainfall data and anomalies for March-April 2026, seasonal forecasts, and assumptions for the 2026/27 season
Displaced populations	IOM , OCHA , UNHCR , Chad government; Partner reports	Quantitative	Trends in the movements of refugee populations, internally displaced persons (IDPs), Chadian returnees from the Central African Republic at risk of statelessness, Chadian returnees from the Lake Chad Basin, asylum seekers, and funding for assistance plans
Agricultural production (cereals and other cash crops)	Final results of the agricultural survey from the Ministry of Agricultural Production and Industrialization, Central Directorate of Statistics, and SISAAP regional focal points	Quantitative	Impact of agricultural production on the availability of local food commodities (at both household and market levels) and employment opportunities in the agricultural sector
Prices of agricultural and livestock products	Reports from partners and SISAAP regional focal points	Quantitative	Trends and impacts of staple food prices on household purchasing power
Monthly monitoring of the food and nutrition situation in the provinces	Monthly price bulletins from the Agricultural Market Information System (SIMPA)	Quantitative	Data on the agricultural and pastoral situation, markets, livestock movements, diseases, and their impact on food security and nutrition
SISAAP lean season response plan	Livestock Market Information System (SIM Livestock) of the Ministry of Livestock and Animal Production of Chad	Quantitative	Assistance program, June-August 2026

Annex 2: Seasonal calendar



Annex 3: Projected acute food insecurity outcomes and areas receiving significant levels of humanitarian assistance

Each of these maps adheres to IPC v3.1 humanitarian assistance mapping protocols and flags where significant levels of humanitarian assistance are being/are expected to be provided. 🍲 indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average 25-50 percent of caloric needs from humanitarian food assistance (HFA). 🍲 indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average over 50 percent of caloric needs through HFA. This mapping protocol differs from the (!) protocol used in the maps at the top of the report. The use of (!) indicates areas that would likely be at least one phase worse in the absence of current or programmed humanitarian assistance.



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* FEWS NET classification is **IPC-compatible** with limited exceptions. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. As of IPC 3.0, the IPC no longer assesses the impact of food assistance on classification and thus no longer maps the (!). However, FEWS NET continues to produce food security maps inclusive of the (!) as well as maps compatible with IPC 3.0/3.1, which include the mapping of food security assistance bags. In rare cases, FEWS NET classification is IPC-aligned but not IPC-compatible. IPC-aligned analysis is evidence-based but some types of evidence required for IPC-compatibility were not available.

Food Security Outlook Update

This Food Security Outlook Update provides an analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography over the next six months. Learn more [here](#).